



United States
Attorney's Office
District of Connecticut



Wethersfield Woman Admits Role in Scheme that Defrauded Connecticut's Medicaid Program of More Than \$1.8 Million



Wednesday, April 30, 2025

For Immediate Release

U.S. Attorney's Office, District of
Connecticut

Marc H. Silverman, Acting United States Attorney for the District of Connecticut, announced that SUHAIL APONTE, 38, of Wethersfield, waived her right to be indicted and pleaded guilty today before U.S. District Judge Stefan R. Underhill in Bridgeport to a health care fraud offense related to a Medicaid fraud scheme.

The Connecticut Medical Assistance Program (CTMAP) is a Connecticut Department of Social Services-administered program that provides medical assistance to low income persons. CTMAP's benefit packages, referred to as "HUSKY" or "Connecticut Medicaid," are jointly funded by the State of Connecticut and the federal government.

According to court documents and statements made in court, Aponte was the sole principal and registered agent of Minds Cornerstone LLC, dba Minds Cornerstone Behavior Therapy Services ("Minds Cornerstone"), an Autism Specialist Group, which was registered with the State of Connecticut in June 2021. Beginning in approximately November 2021, Aponte, who is not a licensed provider, was involved in a scheme in which she and a co-conspirator used Minds Cornerstone to defraud the Connecticut Medicaid Program by submitting fraudulent claims for applied behavior analysis ("ABA") services to children diagnosed with Autism Spectrum Disorder ("ASD"). The scheme involved billing for Medicaid for services purportedly rendered to patients when company payroll records indicate employees were not compensated for the associated services; direct supervision services purportedly provided by a Board Certified Behavior Analyst ("BCBA") of a behavioral technician, when the corresponding procedure code for behavioral technician services was not billed; services purportedly rendered to

patients who were actually in an inpatient hospital; and services purportedly rendered when parents of patients and former employees of Minds Cornerstone confirmed those services did not occur.

Between November 2021 and January 2025, Aponte and her co-conspirator submitted or caused to be submitted to Medicaid fraudulent claims that resulted in a loss of approximately \$1,876,617 to the Connecticut Department of Social Services.

From approximately May 2022 until November 2024, Aponte was also employed by the State of Connecticut in the Office of Policy and Management.

Aponte pleaded guilty to conspiracy to commit health care fraud, which carries a maximum term of imprisonment of 10 years.

As part of her plea, Aponte has agreed to the forfeiture of approximately \$459,000 in funds seized from various bank accounts she controlled, as well as her interest in additional bank accounts and two parcels of land in Hartford.

Judge Underhill scheduled sentencing for July 30.

Aponte has been released on a \$100,000 bond since her arrest on January 16, 2025.

This investigation is being conducted by the Federal Bureau of Investigation, the U.S. Department of Health and Human Services, Office of the Inspector General (HHS-OIG), and the Medicaid Fraud Control Unit of the Connecticut Chief State’s Attorney’s Office, with the assistance of the Connecticut Department of Social Services. The case is being prosecuted by Assistant U.S. Attorney David T. Huang.

Updated April 30, 2025

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